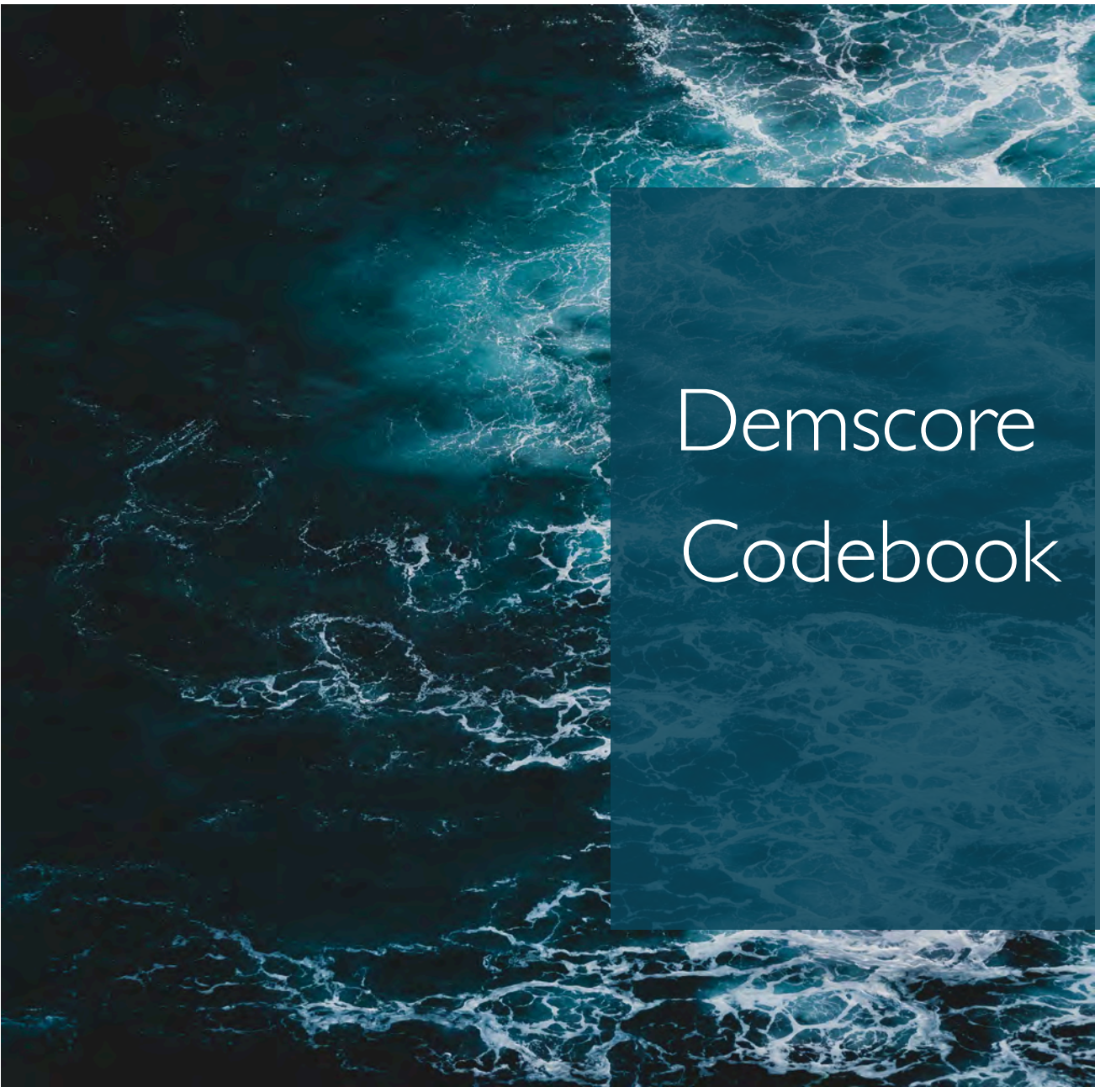
demscore



Demscore Codebook

March 2026

Data version: 7.0
Document version: 7.0

Copyright © Demscore
All rights reserved

Funders: Demscore is funded by the Swedish Research Council, University of Gothenburg, Stockholm University, Uppsala University, and Umeå University. For more information, please visit: `https://demscore.se`

For data enquiries: contact@demscore.se

Summary of Table of Contents

1 Explanatory Notes **5**
1.1 Release Notes v7 . . . 5
1.2 New in Demscore version 7 . . . 5
1.3 The Demscore Codebook . . . 6
1.4 Methodology . . . 6
1.5 Citations . . . 6
1.6 Missing Data . . . 6
1.7 Download ID . . . 7
1.8 Unit Identifier Variables . . . 7
1.9 Output Unit Identifier Variables in the Chosen Unit . . . 7

2 QOG **8**
2.1 QoG OECD Dataset Time-Series . . . 8
2.1.1 Conflict and Military Service . . . 9
2.1.2 Public Economy . . . 10
2.1.3 Judicial . . . 11
2.1.4 Gender Equality . . . 11
2.1.5 Quality of Government . . . 12
2.1.6 Education . . . 14
2.2 QoG Standard Dataset Time-Series . . . 15
2.2.1 Conflict and Military Service . . . 15
2.2.2 Education . . . 16
2.2.3 Public Economy . . . 18
2.2.4 Judicial . . . 19
2.2.5 Gender Equality . . . 19
2.2.6 Quality of Government . . . 20

3 Bibliography **23**

Table of Contents

1 Explanatory Notes **5**

1.1 Release Notes v7 . . . 5
1.2 New in Demscore version 7 . . . 5
1.3 The Demscore Codebook . . . 6
1.4 Methodology . . . 6
1.5 Citations . . . 6
1.6 Missing Data . . . 6
1.7 Download ID . . . 7
1.8 Unit Identifier Variables . . . 7
1.9 Output Unit Identifier Variables in the Chosen Unit . . . 7

2 QOG **8**

2.1 QoG OECD Dataset Time-Series . . . 8
2.1.1 Conflict and Military Service . . . 9
2.1.1.1 Global Militarization Index (bicc_gmi) . . . 9
2.1.2 Public Economy . . . 10
2.1.2.1 Central Bank Independence weighted index (cbi_cbiw) . . . 10
2.1.2.2 Gini index (wdi_gini) . . . 10
2.1.2.3 Tax revenue (percent of GDP) (wdi_taxrev) . . . 10
2.1.3 Judicial . . . 11
2.1.3.1 Rule of Law (fh_rol) . . . 11
2.1.4 Gender Equality . . . 11
2.1.4.1 Overall Global Gender Gap Index (gggi_ggi) . . . 11
2.1.5 Quality of Government . . . 12
2.1.5.1 ICRG Indicator of Quality of Government (icrg_qog) . . . 12
2.1.5.2 Corruption Perceptions Index (ti_cpi) . . . 13
2.1.5.3 Government Effectiveness, Estimate (wbgi_gee) . . . 13
2.1.6 Education . . . 14
2.1.6.1 School enrollment, secondary (percent gross) (wdi_gers) . . . 14
2.1.6.2 School enrollment, secondary, female (percent gross) (wdi_gersf) . . . 14
2.1.6.3 School enrollment, secondary, male (percent gross) (wdi_gersm) . . . 14
2.2 QoG Standard Dataset Time-Series . . . 15
2.2.1 Conflict and Military Service . . . 15
2.2.1.1 Global Militarization Index (bicc_gmi) . . . 15
2.2.2 Education . . . 16
2.2.2.1 Sustainability (bti_su) . . . 16
2.2.2.2 School enrollment, secondary (percent gross) (wdi_gers) . . . 17
2.2.2.3 School enrollment, secondary, female (percent gross) (wdi_gersf) . . . 17
2.2.2.4 School enrollment, secondary, male (percent gross) (wdi_gersm) . . . 17
2.2.3 Public Economy . . . 18
2.2.3.1 Central Bank Independence weighted index (cbi_cbiw) . . . 18
2.2.3.2 Gini index (wdi_gini) . . . 18
2.2.3.3 Tax revenue (percent of GDP) (wdi_taxrev) . . . 18
2.2.4 Judicial . . . 19
2.2.4.1 Rule of Law (fh_rol) . . . 19
2.2.5 Gender Equality . . . 19
2.2.5.1 Overall Global Gender Gap Index (gggi_ggi) . . . 19

2.2.6 Quality of Government 20
2.2.6.1 ICRG Indicator of Quality of Government (icrg_qog) 20
2.2.6.2 Corruption Perceptions Index (ti_cpi) 21
2.2.6.3 Government Effectiveness, Estimate (wbgi_gee) 21

3 Bibliography **23**

1 Explanatory Notes

1.1 Release Notes v7

Demscore provides worldwide free access to harmonized data on Democracy, Environment, Migration, Social Policy, Conflict and Representation from several of the world's most prominent social science research institutes. The interdisciplinary nature of Demscore data facilitates large-scale comparative analyses. This is essential to advance adequate policy responses to complex societal challenges associated with the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and beyond, facing Sweden, Europe, and the world today.

With a firm commitment to transparency and openness, Demscore v7 enables users to gain comprehensive insights into various topics across the social sciences. The joint infrastructure ensures data integrity and quality at the highest international standards and maximizes usability in the measurement of contextual data with over 25.000 variables across nearly all countries in the world, from 1750 to the present.

This creates critical time- and cost saving advantages in data collection, management, distribution, and not the least for end-users in the scientific community. Demscore's unique approach to translating and merging data scales up to more than 410.000 variable versions available in the infrastructure, storing more than 10 billion non-missing observations.

This collaborative effort between leading Swedish universities pushes the scale of social science data to a new level and offers unprecedented possibilities for interdisciplinary research and knowledge advancement.

These are the key features of Demscore:

1. **Customized Download:** A fully normalized, joint PostgreSQL database, sophisticated programming, and a user-friendly web-based interface for users to generate custom-designed datasets and codebooks for download.
2. **Translations and Data Merges:** Demscore currently offers more than 1100 merge options between datasets.
3. **Metadata:** Demscore takes information on and organization of metadata to new heights with the inclusion of customized codebooks, a detailed methodology document, and a comprehensive handbook.
4. **Handling of Missing Data:** Demscore pioneers in developing an innovative approach to tackle missing data. Researchers can now account for missing values with increased precision, leading to more robust and reliable analyses.
5. **Merge Scores:** Demscore introduces a unique merge mechanism. This powerful tool enables researchers to combine datasets effortlessly, uncovering connections and patterns that were previously hidden in isolated data silos.
6. **Thematic Datasets:** Demscore provides researchers with curated thematic datasets, each focused on a specific topic. These datasets bring together relevant variables from across the Demscore partners, facilitating in-depth investigations and comprehensive analyses of specific domains.
7. **Interactive Web Portal:** In addition to all the above, Demscore's web portal offers interactive visualization tools, user support and additional information on all partners and data sources.

For more information, please visit `https://www.demscore.se/` or contact contact@demscore.se.

1.2 New in Demscore version 7

A detailed description of changes and additions made for version 7 compared to version 6 can be found in the Methodology Document.

1.3 The Demscore Codebook

The autogenerated Demscore Codebook lists variable entries for those variables chosen by the user along with citation guidelines and licenses per variable.

The meta data is extracted from the codebooks per dataset stored in a table in the Demscore PostgreSQL database with one row per variable for all datasets. This table includes codebook entries, variable tags, labels, and other variable information in LaTeX format used to generate an automated codebook.
Demscore maintains a single set of standard entries for metadata across all datasets, to which all project members contribute their information. Additionally, variables within different datasets may have varying sets of additional information requirements specific to each dataset. These dataset-specific entries are also included, but they are presented as variable-specific metadata beneath the standard entries.
At the outset of the harmonization process, Demscore underwent a thorough variable name cleanup. This involved tasks such as replacing spaces or dots in variable names with underscores and converting all letters to lowercase. Notably, the original tags remain preserved and stored in the PostgreSQL table. Each variable in Demscore is accessible in both short and long forms. The short form comprises the cleaned version of the original variable tag, while the long form starts with the dataset name from which it originates, followed by the cleaned variable name.

For instance, the original name of the variable *MinisterPersonalID* from the H-DATA Foreign Minister Dataset is included as *ministerpersonalid* (short form) and *hdata_fomin_ministerpersonalid* (long form) in Demscore.

In addition, each dataset includes Demscore unit-identifier variables which are named according to the following naming scheme: Beginning with u_, followed by the name of the primary unit and finally the variable tag. The *year*- variable from the COMPLAB SPIN The Out-of-Work Benefits Dataset (OUTWB), which is part of the primary unit u_complab_country_year has the Demscore unit identifier name *u_complab_country_year_year*.

1.4 Methodology

For details on our methodology please see the Demscore Methodology document available for download on the Demscore website.

1.5 Citations

The Demscore project does not have a formal citation of its own. Hence, when using Demscore, we suggest that you cite the respective projects and datasets. We indicate how every dataset is to be cited in the autogenerated codebook you retreive with your data download, both in the dataset description and the codebook entry for each variable. Most often it is sufficient to cite the dataset a variable originates from, but sometimes there is a variable specific citation listed in the codebook entry in addition to that. For these cases, please also add the variable specific citation to the reference list of your publication. Full references are linked in the codebook entries of the variables and listed in the codebook's bibliography. We suggest you to also cite the Demscore Methodology Document when using data retrieved through Demscore.

1.6 Missing Data

Demscore indicates different types of missingness for observations in the customized datasets:
Missing in original data = Whenever an observation in the original variable is a missing (NA, missing code such as 7777, blank cell), we preserve this missing value. When the original source has special codes for various types of missing, those are preserved.
Missing code: -11111 = Demscore code for observation is missing due to the translation/merge, i.e., missing data due to no data being included for this combination of identifiers in the end Output Unit.
Missing code: -22222 = No observation is merged/translated, but the original data contains information for these identifier combinations elsewhere. For these cases, we use a different code. The

user needs to consult the reference documents (Methodology Document Section 5.1. or the Demscore Handbook) to clarify why the translation to the identifier combinations in the end Output Unit was not possible.

Please note that an observation that is missing in its original output unit does no take the value -11111, but appears as NA/blank cell in the customized dataset.

1.7 Download ID

The download ID can be shared with other users for replication purposes. A user can type the download ID into the Demscore website and retrieve the same download selection and files as the original user. This ID is autogenerated for each download from the Demscore website and will always retrieve the same data, even if the Demscore version was updated in the meantime.

Download ID: 81929b1e-8ab2-4409-a3e1-ffaff751c039

1.8 Unit Identifier Variables

An Output Unit is defined as an output format in which variables can be retrieved from one or more datasets through a strictly defined output grid. A unit table defining this output grid contains unit identifier columns with u_ prefixes and the table is sorted based on these unit identifier columns and has a fixed number of rows. Unit columns are based on the columns that constitute the unit of analysis in a dataset. They are added to the original dataset and marked by a unit prefix (consisting of a u_ and the dataset unit name) before the original variable name. Unit columns can contain slightly modified data, e.g., missing values are replaced by a default value. Sometimes we add additional columns to the unit table, for instance if a dataset includes both a country_id column with a numeric country code, we add the variable storing the full country name to the unit table as well for better readability.

1.9 Output Unit Identifier Variables in the Chosen Unit

u_qog_country_year_ccode: The column is a duplicate of *ccodealp* in the following datasets: QoG Standard Dataset Time-Series QoG OECD Dataset Time-Series QoG European Quality of Government Index CATI - Country Level (2021) QoG Environmental Indicators

u_qog_country_year_ccodealp: The column is a duplicate of *ccodealp* in the following datasets: QoG Standard Dataset Time-Series QoG OECD Dataset Time-Series QoG European Quality of Government Index CATI - Country Level (2021) QoG Environmental Indicators

u_qog_country_year_ccodecow: The column is a duplicate of *ccodealp* in the following datasets: QoG Standard Dataset Time-Series QoG OECD Dataset Time-Series QoG European Quality of Government Index CATI - Country Level (2021) QoG Environmental Indicators

u_qog_country_year_country: The column is a duplicate of *ccodealp* in the following datasets: QoG Standard Dataset Time-Series QoG OECD Dataset Time-Series QoG European Quality of Government Index CATI - Country Level (2021) QoG Environmental Indicators

u_qog_country_year_year: The column is a duplicate of *ccodealp* in the following datasets: QoG Standard Dataset Time-Series QoG OECD Dataset Time-Series QoG European Quality of Government Index CATI - Country Level (2021) QoG Environmental Indicators

2 QOG

The **Quality of Government (QoG)** Institute was founded in 2004 by Professor Bo Rothstein and Professor Sören Holmberg. It is an independent research institute within the Department of Political Science at the University of Gothenburg. QoG is comprised of about 30 researchers who conduct and promote research on the causes, consequences and nature of Good Governance and the Quality of Government (QoG) - that is, trustworthy, reliable, impartial, uncorrupted and competent government institutions. QoG's award-winning datasets focus on concepts related to quality of government, transparency, and public administration. The main objective of QoG's research is to address the theoretical and empirical problem of how political institutions of high quality can be created and maintained. A second objective is to study the effects of Quality of Government on a number of policy areas, such as health, the environment, social policy, and poverty. The QoG datasets draw on a number of freely available datasources. More information on how the variables are complied for different QoG datasets can be found in the respective QoG codebooks available on their website. More information is available on the project's website: `https://www.gu.se/en/quality-government`

2.1 QoG OECD Dataset Time-Series

Dataset tag: qog_oecd_ts

Output Unit: QoG Country-Year, i.e., data is collected per country and year. That means there is one row for each combination of country and year in the dataset. This unit is identified using the cname column and the year column.

Description: The QoG OECD dataset consists of approximately 1300 variables from 100 data sources. The dataset includes OECD member countries and has high data coverage in terms of geography and time.
In the QoG OECD TS dataset, data from 1946 to 2024 is included and the unit of analysis is country-year (e.g., Sweden-1946, Sweden-1947, etc.).

Dataset citation: Teorell, Jan, Staffan Kumlin, Aksel Sundström, Sören Holmberg, Bo Rothstein, Natalia Alvarado Pachon, Victor Saidi Phiri, Chuwei Chen, and Zhen Liu. 2026. The Quality of Government OECD Dataset, version Jan26. University of Gothenburg: The Quality of Government Institute, https://www.gu.se/en/quality-government.
https://doi.org/10.18157/qogoecdjan26

QoG Data is part of and funded by DEMSCORE, national research infrastructure grant 2021-00162 from the Swedish Research Council.

Link to original codebook
`https://www.qogdata.pol.gu.se/data/codebook_oecd_jan26.pdf`

License: The QoG datasets are open and available, free of charge and without a need to register your data. You can use them for your analysis, graphs, teaching, and other academic-related and non-commercial purposes. We ask our users to cite always the original source(s) of the data and our datasets.

We do not allow other uses of these data including but not limited to redistribution, commercialization and other for-profit usage. If a user is interested in such use or has doubts about the license, they will have to refer to the original source and check with them if this is allowed and what requirements they need to fulfill.

Be mindful that the original data sources are the only owners of their data and they can adjust their license without previous warning.

More detailed information on the dataset can be found at the following web page: `https://www.gu.se/en/quality-government/qog-data/data-downloads/oecd-dataset`

2.1.1 Conflict and Military Service

This category includes variables concerning armed conflict, including civil war and terrorism, govern- ment revenue and spending related to violent conflict (military expenditure, arms imports, military personnel).

2.1.1.1 Global Militarization Index (bicc_gmi)

Long tag: qog_oecd_ts_bicc_gmi

Original tag: bicc_gmi

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*a*)

Variable citation: Bayer, Markus and Rohleder, Paul (2022)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 1005, Percent: 7.9

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 1005, Percent: 7.9

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

The Global Militarization Index is divided into three overarching categories: expenditure, personnel and heavy weapons. (See variables bicc_milexp, bicc_milper, and bicc_hw).

In order to increase the compatibility between different indicators and preventing extreme values from crating distortions when normalizing data, in a first step every indicator was represented in a logarithm with the factor 10. Second, all data was normalized using the formula x=(y-min)/(max-min), with min and max representing, respectively, the lowest and the highest value of the logarithm. In a third step, every indicator was weighted in accordance to a subjective factor, reflecting the relative importance attributed to it by BICC researchers. In order to calculate the final score, the weighted indicators were added together and then normalized one last time on a scale ranging from 0 to 1,000. For better comparison of individual years, all years were finally normalized.

Weighting Factors used:

Military expenditures as percentage of GDP - 5

Military expenditures in relation to health spending - 3

Military and paramilitary personnel in relation to population - 4

Military reservers in relation to population - 2

Military and paramilitary personnel in relation to physicians - 2

Heavy weapons in relation to population - 4

2.1.2 Public Economy

This category includes economic indicators that reflect the involvement of the government in the economy (taxes, tariff rates and government expenditures), economic key figures of a state (GDP, inflation, and economic inequality), and indicators that characterize the state of the economy (aid-flows, debt).

2.1.2.1 Central Bank Independence weighted index (cbi_cbiw)

Long tag: qog_oecd_ts_cbi_cbiw

Original tag: cbi_cbiw

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*a*)

Variable citation: Garriga (2025)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 1596, Percent: 12.55

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 1596, Percent: 12.55

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

CBI weighted index: Weighted average of the four components (weights between parentheses), following Cukierman, Webb and Neyapti's (1992) criteria: Chief Executive Officer (0.20), Objectives (0.15), Policy Formulation (0.15), and Limitations on lending to the government (0.5). It ranges from 0 (minimum) to 1 (maximum) CBI.

2.1.2.2 Gini index (wdi_gini)

Long tag: qog_oecd_ts_wdi_gini

Original tag: wdi_gini

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*a*)

Variable citation: World Bank (2024)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 819, Percent: 6.44

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 819, Percent: 6.44

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

Gini index measures the extent to which the distribution of income (or, in some cases, consumption expenditure) among individuals or households within an economy deviates from a perfectly equal distribution. A Lorenz curve plots the cumulative percentages of total income received against the cumulative number of recipients, starting with the poorest individual or household. The Gini index measures the area between the Lorenz curve and a hypothetical line of absolute equality, expressed as a percentage of the maximum area under the line. Thus a Gini index of 0 represents perfect equality, while an index of 100 implies perfect inequality.

2.1.2.3 Tax revenue (percent of GDP) (wdi_taxrev)

Long tag: qog_oecd_ts_wdi_taxrev

Original tag: wdi_taxrev

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*a*)

Variable citation: World Bank (2024)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 1341, Percent: 10.55

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 1341, Percent: 10.55

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

Tax revenue refers to compulsory transfers to the central government for public purposes.

Certain compulsory transfers such as fines, penalties, and most social security contributions are excluded. Refunds and corrections of erroneously collected tax revenue are treated as negative revenue.

Note: The value for San Marino for 1995 was extremely high (44326) and has been recoded to missing.

2.1.3 Judicial

This category includes judicial indicators, generally covering legal rights granted by a state to its citizens and their compliance, as well as measures of crimes and the overall state of the judicial system.

2.1.3.1 Rule of Law (fh_rol)

Long tag: qog_oecd_ts_fh_rol

Original tag: fh_rol

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*a*)

Variable citation: Freedom House (2024)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 640, Percent: 5.03

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 640, Percent: 5.03

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

Rule of Law - The variable measures the independence of the judiciary; the extent to which rule of law prevails in civil and criminal matters; the existence of direct civil control over the police; the protection from political terror, unjustified imprisonment, exile and torture; absence of war and insurgencies; and the extent to which laws, policies and practices guarantee equal treatment of various segments of the population. Countries are graded between 0 (worst) and 16 (best).

2.1.4 Gender Equality

This category includes variables related to the differences of access and opportunities between women and men by country, such as access to education, overall employment and employment by specific sectors, and indexes that shine a light on the general differences in treatment between men and women.

2.1.4.1 Overall Global Gender Gap Index (gggi_ggi)

Long tag: qog_oecd_ts_gggi_ggi

Original tag: gggi_ggi

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*a*)

Variable citation: World Economic Forum (2024)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 576, Percent: 4.53

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 576, Percent: 4.53

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

The Global Gender Gap Index (0 to 1, where 1 indicates no gap) examines the gap between men and women in four fundamental categories (subindexes): Economic Participation and Opportunity, Educational Attainment, Health and Survival and Political Empowerment.

2.1.5 Quality of Government

This category includes variables that are the core features of QoG (impartiality, bureaucratic quality and corruption) as well as measures that are broader (rule of law and transparency).

2.1.5.1 ICRG Indicator of Quality of Government (icrg_qog)

Long tag: qog_oecd_ts_icrg_qog

Original tag: icrg_qog

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*a*)

Variable citation: The PRS Group et al. (2025)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 1267, Percent: 9.97

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 1267, Percent: 9.97

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

The mean value of the ICRG variables 'Corruption', 'Law and Order' and 'Bureaucracy Quality', scaled from 0 to 1. Higher values indicate higher quality of government.

Corruption:

This is an assessment of corruption within the political system. Such corruption is a threat to foreign investment for several reasons: it distorts the economic and financial environment; it reduces the efficiency of government and business by enabling people to assume positions of power through patronage rather than ability; and, last but not least, it introduces an inherent instability into the political process. The most common form of corruption met directly by business is financial corruption in the form of demands for special payments and bribes connected with import and export licenses, exchange controls, tax assessments, police protection, or loans. Such corruption can make it difficult to conduct business effectively, and in some cases may force the withdrawal or withholding of an investment. Although the measure takes such corruption into account, it is more concerned with actual or potential corruption in the form of excessive patronage, nepotism, job reservations, 'favor-for-favors', secret party funding, and suspiciously close ties between politics and business. According to ICRG, these insidious sorts of corruption are potentially of much greater risk to foreign business in that they can lead to popular discontent, unrealistic and inefficient controls on the state economy, and encourage the development of the black market. The greatest risk in such corruption is that at some time it will become so overweening, or some major scandal will be suddenly revealed, so as to provoke a popular backlash, resulting in a fall or overthrow of the government, a major reorganizing or restructuring of the country's political institutions, or, at worst, a breakdown in law and order, rendering the country ungovernable.

Law and order:

Law and Order are assessed separately, with each sub-component comprising zero to three points. The Law sub-component is an assessment of the strength and impartiality of the legal

system, while the Order sub-component is an assessment of popular observance of the law. Thus, a country can enjoy a high rating in terms of its judicial system, but a low rating if it suffers from a very high crime rate or if the law is routinely ignored without effective sanction (for example, widespread illegal strikes).

Bureaucracy Quality:

The institutional strength and quality of the bureaucracy is another shock absorber that tends to minimize revisions of policy when governments change. Therefore, high points are given to countries where the bureaucracy has the strength and expertise to govern without drastic changes in policy or interruptions in government services. In these low-risk countries, the bureaucracy tends to be somewhat autonomous from political pressure and to have an established mechanism for recruitment and training. Countries that lack the cushioning effect of a strong bureaucracy receive low points because a change in government tends to be traumatic in terms of policy formulation and day-to-day administrative functions.

The component variables can be purchased at https://epub.prsgroup.com/products/icrg

2.1.5.2 Corruption Perceptions Index (ti_cpi)

Long tag: qog_oecd_ts_ti_cpi

Original tag: ti_cpi

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*a*)

Variable citation: Transparency International (2024)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 416, Percent: 3.27

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 416, Percent: 3.27

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

Corruption Perceptions Index. Scale of 0-100 where 0 equals the highest level of perceived corruption and 100 equals the lowest level of perceived corruption.

2.1.5.3 Government Effectiveness, Estimate (wbgi_gee)

Long tag: qog_oecd_ts_wbgi_gee

Original tag: wbgi_gee

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*a*)

Variable citation: Kaufmann & Kraay (n.d.)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 832, Percent: 6.54

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 832, Percent: 6.54

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

Government Effectiveness - Estimate: 'Government Effectiveness' combines into a single grouping responses on the quality of public service provision, the quality of the bureaucracy, the competence of civil servants, the independence of the civil service from political pressures, and the credibility of the government's commitment to policies. The main focus of this index

is on 'inputs' required for the government to be able to produce and implement good policies and deliver public goods.

2.1.6 Education

This category includes a variety of indicators related to education, such as key characteristics of the educational system (public expenditure, gross enrollment, number of teachers), the students (age, gender, educational level), and educational outcomes (mean scores, literacy rates, numbers of researchers and scientists).

2.1.6.1 School enrollment, secondary (percent gross) (wdi_gers)

Long tag: qog_oecd_ts_wdi_gers

Original tag: wdi_gers

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*a*)

Variable citation: World Bank (2024)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 724, Percent: 5.69

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 724, Percent: 5.69

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

Total enrollment in secondary education, regardless of age, expressed as a percentage of the population of official secondary education age. GER can exceed 100percent due to the inclusion of over-aged and under-aged students because of early or late school entrance and grade repetition.

2.1.6.2 School enrollment, secondary, female (percent gross) (wdi_gersf)

Long tag: qog_oecd_ts_wdi_gersf

Original tag: wdi_gersf

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*a*)

Variable citation: World Bank (2024)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 723, Percent: 5.69

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 723, Percent: 5.69

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

Total female enrollment in secondary education, regardless of age, expressed as a percentage of the female population of official secondary education age. GER can exceed 100percent due to the inclusion of over-aged and under-aged students because of early or late school entrance and grade repetition.

2.1.6.3 School enrollment, secondary, male (percent gross) (wdi_gersm)

Long tag: qog_oecd_ts_wdi_gersm

Original tag: wdi_gersm

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*a*)

Variable citation: World Bank (2024)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 723, Percent: 5.69

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 723, Percent: 5.69

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

Total male enrollment in secondary education, regardless of age, expressed as a percentage of

the male population of official secondary education age. GER can exceed 100percent due to the inclusion of over-aged and under-aged students because of early or late school entrance and grade repetition.

2.2 QoG Standard Dataset Time-Series

Dataset tag: qog_std_ts

Output Unit: QoG Country-Year, i.e., data is collected per country and year. That means there is one row for each combination of country and year in the dataset. This unit is identified using the cname column and the year column.

Description: The QoG Standard dataset is our largest dataset. It consists of approximately 2100 variables from more than 100 data sources related to Quality of Government. In the QoG Standard TS dataset, data from 1946 to 2024 is included and the unit of analysis is country-year (e.g., Sweden-1946, Sweden-1947, etc.).

Dataset citation: Teorell, Jan, Aksel Sundström, Sören Holmberg, Bo Rothstein, Natalia Alvarado Pachon, Cem Mert Dalli, Rafael Lopez Valverde, Victor Saidi Phiri Lauren Gerber. 2025. The Quality of Government Standard Dataset, version Jan25. University of Gothenburg: The Quality of Government Institute, https://www.gu.se/en/quality-government doi:10.18157/qogstdjan25. University of Gothenburg: The Quality of Government Institute, `https://www.gu.se/en/quality-government doi:10.18157/qogstdjan24`

QoG Data is part of and funded by DEMSCORE, national research infrastructure grant 2021-00162 from the Swedish Research Council.

Link to original codebook
`https://www.qogdata.pol.gu.se/data/codebook_std_jan25.pdf`

License: The QoG datasets are open and available, free of charge and without a need to register your data. You can use them for your analysis, graphs, teaching, and other academic-related and non-commercial purposes. We ask our users to cite always the original source(s) of the data and our datasets.

We do not allow other uses of these data including but not limited to redistribution, commercialization and other for-profit usage. If a user is interested in such use or has doubts about the license, they will have to refer to the original source and check with them if this is allowed and what requirements they need to fulfill.

Be mindful that the original data sources are the only owners of their data and they can adjust their license without previous warning.

More detailed information on the dataset can be found at the following web page: `https://www.gu.se/en/quality-government/qog-data/data-downloads/standard-dataset`

2.2.1 Conflict and Military Service

This category includes variables concerning armed conflict, including civil war and terrorism, govern- ment revenue and spending related to violent conflict (military expenditure, arms imports, military personnel).

2.2.1.1 Global Militarization Index (bicc_gmi)

Long tag: qog_std_ts_bicc_gmi

Original tag: bicc_gmi

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*b*)

Variable citation: Bayer, Markus and Rohleder, Paul (2022)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 4999, Percent: 39.32

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 4999, Percent: 39.32

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

The Global Militarization Index is divided into three overarching categories: expenditure, personnel and heavy weapons. (See variables bicc_milexp, bicc_milper, and bicc_hw).

In order to increase the compatibility between different indicators and preventing extreme values from crating distortions when normalizing data, in a first step every indicator was represented in a logarithm with the factor 10. Second, all data was normalized using the formula x=(y-min)/(max-min), with min and max representing, respectively, the lowest and the highest value of the logarithm. In a third step, every indicator was weighted in accordance to a subjective factor, reflecting the relative importance attributed to it by BICC researchers. In order to calculate the final score, the weighted indicators were added together and then normalized one last time on a scale ranging from 0 to 1,000. For better comparison of individual years, all years were finally normalized.

Weighting Factors used:

Military expenditures as percentage of GDP - 5

Military expenditures in relation to health spending - 3

Military and paramilitary personnel in relation to population - 4

Military reservers in relation to population - 2

Military and paramilitary personnel in relation to physicians - 2

Heavy weapons in relation to population - 4

2.2.2 Education

This category includes a variety of indicators related to education, such as key characteristics of the educational system (public expenditure, gross enrollment, number of teachers), the students (age, gender, educational level), and educational outcomes (mean scores, literacy rates, numbers of researchers and scientists).

2.2.2.1 Sustainability (bti_su)

Long tag: qog_std_ts_bti_su

Original tag: bti_su

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*b*)

Variable citation: Donner et al. (2024)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 1283, Percent: 10.09

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 1283, Percent: 10.09

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

Economic growth is balanced, environmentally sustainable and future-oriented. Including 'To what extent are environmental concerns effectively taken into account?' and 'To what extent are there solid institutions for basic, secondary and tertiary education, as well as for research and development?'.

2.2.2.2 School enrollment, secondary (percent gross) (wdi_gers)

Long tag: qog_std_ts_wdi_gers

Original tag: wdi_gers

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*b*)

Variable citation: World Bank (2024)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 5323, Percent: 41.87

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 5323, Percent: 41.87

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

Total enrollment in secondary education, regardless of age, expressed as a percentage of the population of official secondary education age. GER can exceed 100percent due to the inclusion of over-aged and under-aged students because of early or late school entrance and grade repetition.

2.2.2.3 School enrollment, secondary, female (percent gross) (wdi_gersf)

Long tag: qog_std_ts_wdi_gersf

Original tag: wdi_gersf

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*b*)

Variable citation: World Bank (2024)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 4909, Percent: 38.61

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 4909, Percent: 38.61

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

Total female enrollment in secondary education, regardless of age, expressed as a percentage of the female population of official secondary education age. GER can exceed 100percent due to the inclusion of over-aged and under-aged students because of early or late school entrance and grade repetition.

2.2.2.4 School enrollment, secondary, male (percent gross) (wdi_gersm)

Long tag: qog_std_ts_wdi_gersm

Original tag: wdi_gersm

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*b*)

Variable citation: World Bank (2024)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 4905, Percent: 38.58

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 4905, Percent: 38.58

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

Total male enrollment in secondary education, regardless of age, expressed as a percentage of

the male population of official secondary education age. GER can exceed 100percent due to the inclusion of over-aged and under-aged students because of early or late school entrance and grade repetition.

2.2.3 Public Economy

This category includes economic indicators that reflect the involvement of the government in the economy (taxes, tariff rates and government expenditures), economic key figures of a state (GDP, inflation, and economic inequality), and indicators that characterize the state of the economy (aid-flows, debt).

2.2.3.1 Central Bank Independence weighted index (cbi_cbiw)

Long tag: qog_std_ts_cbi_cbiw

Original tag: cbi_cbiw

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*b*)

Variable citation: Garriga (2025)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 8200, Percent: 64.5

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 8200, Percent: 64.5

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

CBI weighted index: Weighted average of the four components (weights between parentheses), following Cukierman, Webb and Neyapti's (1992) criteria: Chief Executive Officer (0.20), Objectives (0.15), Policy Formulation (0.15), and Limitations on lending to the government (0.5). It ranges from 0 (minimum) to 1 (maximum) CBI.

2.2.3.2 Gini index (wdi_gini)

Long tag: qog_std_ts_wdi_gini

Original tag: wdi_gini

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*b*)

Variable citation: World Bank (2024)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 2363, Percent: 18.59

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 2363, Percent: 18.59

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

Gini index measures the extent to which the distribution of income (or, in some cases, consumption expenditure) among individuals or households within an economy deviates from a perfectly equal distribution. A Lorenz curve plots the cumulative percentages of total income received against the cumulative number of recipients, starting with the poorest individual or household. The Gini index measures the area between the Lorenz curve and a hypothetical line of absolute equality, expressed as a percentage of the maximum area under the line. Thus a Gini index of 0 represents perfect equality, while an index of 100 implies perfect inequality.

2.2.3.3 Tax revenue (percent of GDP) (wdi_taxrev)

Long tag: qog_std_ts_wdi_taxrev

Original tag: wdi_taxrev

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*b*)

Variable citation: World Bank (2024)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 4548, Percent: 35.77

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 4548, Percent: 35.77

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

Tax revenue refers to compulsory transfers to the central government for public purposes. Certain compulsory transfers such as fines, penalties, and most social security contributions are excluded. Refunds and corrections of erroneously collected tax revenue are treated as negative revenue.

Note: The value for San Marino for 1995 was extremely high (44326) and has been recoded to missing.

2.2.4 Judicial

This category includes judicial indicators, generally covering legal rights granted by a state to its citizens and their compliance, as well as measures of crimes and the overall state of the judicial system.

2.2.4.1 Rule of Law (fh_rol)

Long tag: qog_std_ts_fh_rol

Original tag: fh_rol

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*b*)

Variable citation: Freedom House (2024)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 3843, Percent: 30.23

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 3843, Percent: 30.23

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

Rule of Law - The variable measures the independence of the judiciary; the extent to which rule of law prevails in civil and criminal matters; the existence of direct civil control over the police; the protection from political terror, unjustified imprisonment, exile and torture; absence of war and insurgencies; and the extent to which laws, policies and practices guarantee equal treatment of various segments of the population. Countries are graded between 0 (worst) and 16 (best).

2.2.5 Gender Equality

This category includes variables related to the differences of access and opportunities between women and men by country, such as access to education, overall employment and employment by specific sectors, and indexes that shine a light on the general differences in treatment between men and women.

2.2.5.1 Overall Global Gender Gap Index (gggi_ggi)

Long tag: qog_std_ts_gggi_ggi

Original tag: gggi_ggi

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*b*)

Variable citation: World Economic Forum (2024)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 2515, Percent: 19.78

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 2515, Percent: 19.78

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

The Global Gender Gap Index (0 to 1, where 1 indicates no gap) examines the gap between men and women in four fundamental categories (subindexes): Economic Participation and Opportunity, Educational Attainment, Health and Survival and Political Empowerment.

2.2.6 Quality of Government

This category includes variables that are the core features of QoG (impartiality, bureaucratic quality and corruption) as well as measures that are broader (rule of law and transparency).

2.2.6.1 ICRG Indicator of Quality of Government (icrg_qog)

Long tag: qog_std_ts_icrg_qog

Original tag: icrg_qog

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*b*)

Variable citation: The PRS Group et al. (2025)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 5596, Percent: 44.01

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 5596, Percent: 44.01

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

The mean value of the ICRG variables 'Corruption', 'Law and Order' and 'Bureaucracy Quality', scaled from 0 to 1. Higher values indicate higher quality of government.

Corruption:

This is an assessment of corruption within the political system. Such corruption is a threat to foreign investment for several reasons: it distorts the economic and financial environment; it reduces the efficiency of government and business by enabling people to assume positions of power through patronage rather than ability; and, last but not least, it introduces an inherent instability into the political process. The most common form of corruption met directly by business is financial corruption in the form of demands for special payments and bribes connected with import and export licenses, exchange controls, tax assessments, police protection, or loans. Such corruption can make it difficult to conduct business effectively, and in some cases may force the withdrawal or withholding of an investment. Although the measure takes such corruption into account, it is more concerned with actual or potential corruption in the form of excessive patronage, nepotism, job reservations, 'favor-for-favors', secret party funding, and suspiciously close ties between politics and business. According to ICRG, these insidious sorts of corruption are potentially of much greater risk to foreign business in that they can lead to popular discontent, unrealistic and inefficient controls on the state economy, and encourage the development of the black market. The greatest risk in such corruption is that at some time it will become so overweening, or some major scandal will be suddenly revealed, so as to provoke a popular backlash, resulting in a fall or overthrow of the government, a major reorganizing or restructuring of the country's political institutions, or, at worst, a breakdown in law and order, rendering the country ungovernable.

Law and order:

Law and Order are assessed separately, with each sub-component comprising zero to three points. The Law sub-component is an assessment of the strength and impartiality of the legal system, while the Order sub-component is an assessment of popular observance of the law. Thus, a country can enjoy a high rating in terms of its judicial system, but a low rating if it suffers from a very high crime rate or if the law is routinely ignored without effective sanction (for example, widespread illegal strikes).

Bureaucracy Quality:

The institutional strength and quality of the bureaucracy is another shock absorber that tends to minimize revisions of policy when governments change. Therefore, high points are given to countries where the bureaucracy has the strength and expertise to govern without drastic changes in policy or interruptions in government services. In these low-risk countries, the bureaucracy tends to be somewhat autonomous from political pressure and to have an established mechanism for recruitment and training. Countries that lack the cushioning effect of a strong bureaucracy receive low points because a change in government tends to be traumatic in terms of policy formulation and day-to-day administrative functions.

The component variables can be purchased at https://epub.prsgroup.com/products/icrg

2.2.6.2 Corruption Perceptions Index (ti_cpi)

Long tag: qog_std_ts_ti_cpi

Original tag: ti_cpi

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*b*)

Variable citation: Transparency International (2024)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 2270, Percent: 17.85

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 2270, Percent: 17.85

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

Corruption Perceptions Index. Scale of 0-100 where 0 equals the highest level of perceived corruption and 100 equals the lowest level of perceived corruption.

2.2.6.3 Government Effectiveness, Estimate (wbgi_gee)

Long tag: qog_std_ts_wbgi_gee

Original tag: wbgi_gee

Dataset citation: Teorell et al. (2026*b*)

Variable citation: Kaufmann & Kraay (n.d.)

Merge scores:

Non-missing observations in original unit: Sum: 4857, Percent: 38.2

Non-missing observations in chosen unit: Sum: 4857, Percent: 38.2

Lost observations in chosen unit: Sum: 0 Percent: 0

Description:

Government Effectiveness - Estimate: 'Government Effectiveness' combines into a single grouping responses on the quality of public service provision, the quality of the bureaucracy, the competence of civil servants, the independence of the civil service from political pressures, and the credibility of the government's commitment to policies. The main focus of this index is on 'inputs' required for the government to be able to produce and implement good policies and deliver public goods.

3 Bibliography

Bayer, Markus and Rohleder, Paul (2022), *Global Militarization Index 2022*, Bonn International Center for Conversion BICC.
URL: *https://gmi.bicc.de/*

Donner, S., Hartmann, H. & Steinkamp, S. (2024), *Transformation Index BTI 2024: Governance in International Comparison*, Bertelsmann Stiftung.
URL: *http://www.bti-project.org*

Freedom House (2024), 'Freedom in the world 2024'.
URL: *https://freedomhouse.org/report/freedom-world*

Garriga, A. C. (2025), 'Revisiting central bank independence in the world: An extended dataset', *International Studies Quarterly* .
URL: *http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.4816563*

Kaufmann, D. & Kraay, A. (n.d.), 'Worldwide governance indicators, 2024 update'. Accessed on 2024-11-19.
URL: *www.govindicators.org*

Teorell, J., Sundström, A., Holmberg, S., Rothstein, B., Alvarado Pachon, N., Phiri, V. S., Chen, C. & Liu, Z. (2026*a*), *The Quality of Government OECD Dataset, version Jan26*. QoG Data is part of and funded by DEMSCORE, national research infrastructure grant 2021-00162 from the Swedish Research Council.
URL: *https://www.gu.se/en/quality-government*

Teorell, J., Sundström, A., Holmberg, S., Rothstein, B., Alvarado Pachon, N., Phiri, V. S., Chen, C. & Liu, Z. (2026*b*), *The Quality of Government Standard Dataset, version Jan26*. QoG Data is part of and funded by DEMSCORE, national research infrastructure grant 2021-00162 from the Swedish Research Council.
URL: *https://www.gu.se/en/quality-government*

The PRS Group et al. (2025), 'International country risk guide'.

Transparency International (2024), 'Corruption perception index 2023'. Licensed under CC-BY-ND 4.0.
URL: *http://www.transparency.org/cpi*

World Bank (2024), 'World development indicators'.
URL: *https://databank.worldbank.org/source/world-development-indicators*

World Economic Forum (2024), 'The global gender gap report 2024'. All Rights Reserved.
URL: *https://www.weforum.org/publications/global-gender-gap-report-2024/*